

THE ESG BENCHMARK

Mahindra & Mahindra is racing ahead to meet its sustainability goals and making it a group-wide effort

BY ASTHA ORIEL

► **AT A TIME** when sustainability has become a boardroom priority requiring urgent decision-making and transparency, Mahindra & Mahindra has set the benchmark for corporate accountability.

In recognition of these efforts, Mahindra & Mahindra has been selected as the winner in the 'Best Disclosures and Transparency' and 'Best Auto OEM' categories in Business Today's inaugural Most Sustainable Companies Awards. The jury recognised the company's commitment to clear, consistent, and comprehensive ESG (environmental, social and governance) reporting.

"In FY24, we implemented several sustainability-focused projects across our manufacturing facilities, with a strong emphasis on energy conservation," says Rajesh Jejurikar, Executive Director, Auto and Farm Business, at Mahindra & Mahindra.

Jejurikar highlights some of the initiatives taken by the company as an automobile manufacturer. The company replaced traditional air circulators with BLDC technology air circulators. BLDC or brushless direct current technology replaces traditional brushes with electronic controllers to manage current flow.

M&M also enhanced energy efficiency through variable frequency drives (VFDs), interlocks, automation, and digitisation. The company upgraded old motors to premium ef-

iciency IE3 & IE5 motors. It installed automatic shut-off valves and IFC (intelligent flow controller) for compressed air systems. The company recovered waste heat from air compressors and paint shops and utilised smart cooling technology to improve chiller performance and longevity.

"We are the first Indian signatory of EP100 (Energy Productivity 100%) with a target of achieving this by 2030 using 2009 as the baseline year, a programme championed by the climate

group, and successfully reached this goal well ahead of the target date due to these projects," says Jejurikar. EP100 is a global corporate energy efficiency initiative, led by the international nonprofit the Climate Group.

M&M said that one of its most cherished milestones as an auto OEM was validating science-based targets with the international climate action group Science Based Targets initiative (SBTi) across its value chain.

Jejurikar says the company

RAJESH JEJURIKAR ED, AUTO & FARM BUSINESS, M&M



OVERALL

BEST DISCLOSURES & TRANSPARENCY LEADER OF THE YEAR; AUTO OEMs

→ Mahindra & Mahindra is implementing the Science-Based Targets Initiative (SBTi) across its value chain

→ M&M received GNCAP (Global New Car Assessment Programme) certification across its models

→ It won 'Best CSR Initiative Impact' at the National Excellence Awards in 2024

→ M&M received the 'Brandon Hall Group Gold Award' and 'Best Initiative for Philanthropy and Corporate Giving' for its CSR initiatives